



Woldgate School

Of great merit, character & value

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Withdrawal procedure if a parent or carer chooses to withdraw their child from RS, they need to:

- Inform the school of their request for their child(ren) to be withdrawn from RS and/or 'religious assembly' and whether they intend partial or total withdrawal for their child(ren). This should be either in person or in writing to the Headteacher; verbal communication (e.g. on the telephone, through the pupil or student or a note in their books) is not an adequate method.
- Parents/carers will be invited to meet with the Subject Leader for RS and/or the Head of Year, and if necessary, a Deputy Headteacher, to establish with the school their concerns about RS and to discuss the practical implication of withdrawal. At the meeting, the Agreed Syllabus and Schemes of Work will be made available for the parents to read and ask questions about, should they choose to. It is not envisaged that establishing the reason for withdrawal and practicalities of withdrawal from RS be either lengthy or a means to change parent's/carers' minds, but a meeting with the relevant staff is necessary to ensure parents/carers have all relevant and adequate information to make an informed choice.
- It will not be the responsibility of the school or teacher either to set or mark alternative work. Pupils who have been withdrawn will be allocated to different classes or a specified place on an independent basis in order to ensure suitable supervision. These arrangements may need to change from week to week.
- In addition to the above, parents/carers also have the right to opt out of any visits to places of worship. Prior notification will be necessary to ensure adequate supervision is organised for the pupil.
- If a pupil is only to be partially withdrawn from RS lessons that discuss a specific religion or issue, it cannot be guaranteed that reference to these religions or issues in more general lessons does not take place.

Whilst Woldgate School respects the rights of the parents/carers to withdraw their child(ren) from RE, these rights do not apply to a parent's/carers' request to withdraw their child from a non-RE subject that may teach about religion or religious beliefs, e.g. History or English.